HouseScout

Unbiased viewings from abroad

Have you ever struggled renting in London?

Renters compete with 20 others in battle to find a home

Renting in London: ‘It wasn’t OK to go through all this just to find an apartment’

Exhausting, costly, miserable: My search to rent a one-bed flat

I've never had this much trouble finding an apartment in London. I might just move away.

How renting in London became an unimaginable hellscape

London's 'spiralling' housing crisis in numbers

Rents rising at fastest rate for seven years

House prices fall but rents rise 53% in five years

Renters' Rights Act: Here's what it means for you

'IF FIVE OR SIX FLATS ARE AVAILABLE TO RENT IN THE MORNING, THEY'RE GONE BY THE EVENING.'

Report flags ongoing concerns over Renters' Rights Bill

By David Burrows in Market news 27th August 2025 0

Widespread concern across the sector over incoming regulatory changes and the Renters' Rights Bill, have been highlighted in new research by proptech provider Reapit.

200,000 people **moving** from **abroad** every year to **London**

We Interviewed

‘I want my tenant to like it, to stay in the property long term... empty property costs money’ - Oya

10 Landlords
15 Agencies
40 Tenants

‘We want tenants to know what the property looks like before moving in, we don’t want to have problems from day one’

‘Finding a new property is stressful, there’s no way of checking if the property matches ’

Lara is an international who's moving to London soon.

She **must** find a place to rent.

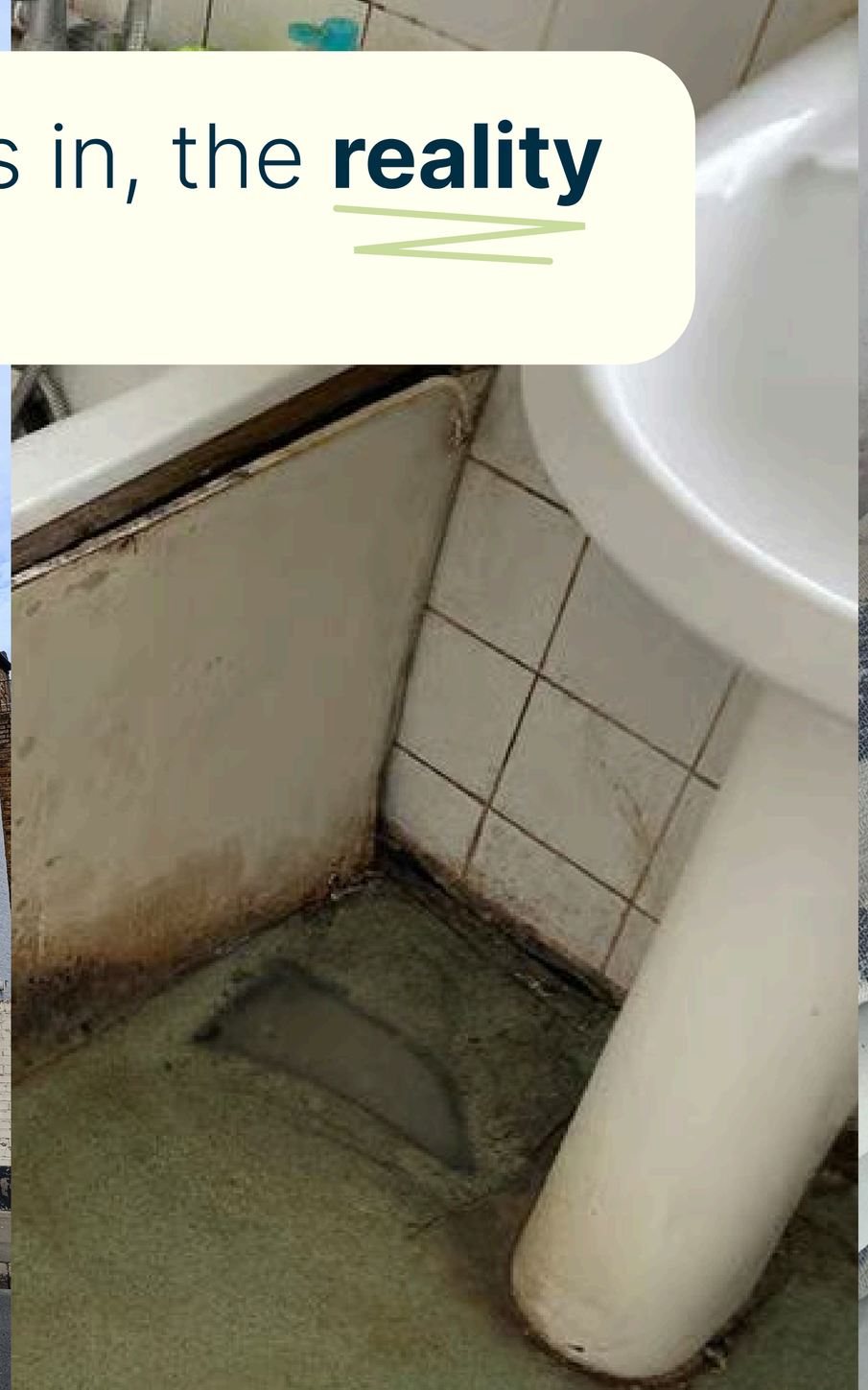
1 Endless time searching online

2 Countless calls and emails to agencies

3 Sign contract without viewing the property **in person**

...and so,

When Lara moves in, the **reality** is very different.



What is to **blame**?

Location Anxiety

Systemic Bias

Inaccurate Property Info

What are the **Current Solutions ?**

HouseScout

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Don’t Rent Blind.
Let Us Check It First.

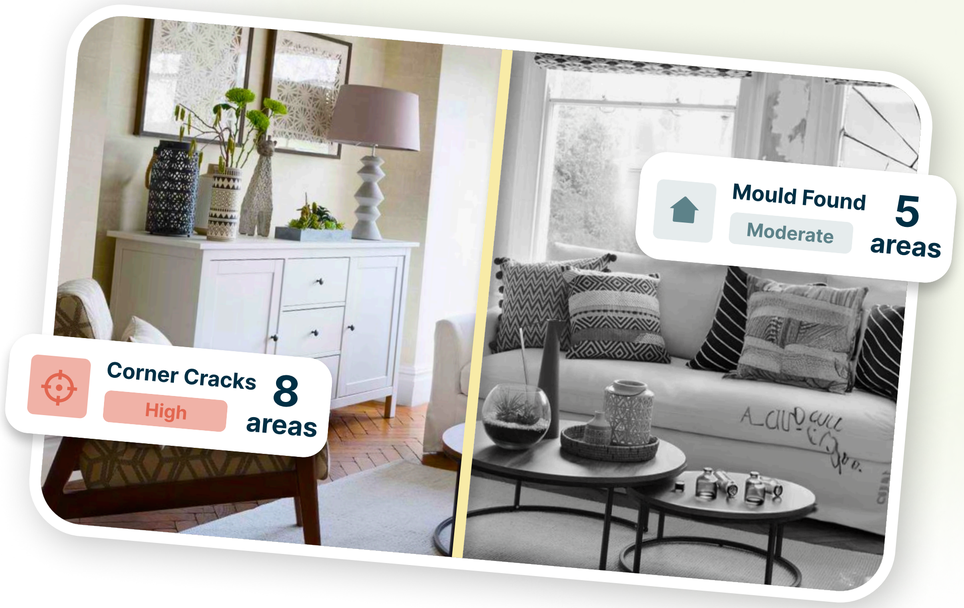
Found a property listing online? Paste the link below. Our local Scouts act as your eyes to verify the truth before you sign.

Trusted by 5,000+ international renters, from students to professionals.

https://Paste the link here... Check House →

Verified scouts Professional reports 500+ resources

Searcher Login Scout Login



I am a Searcher

Rafi Stobbs

ID Verified Graduate Student

Looking in: Kensington & Chelsea

Active 15 mins ago

I like green spaces and want to live in a social area

Build Your Profile

Make it trustworthy!

Profile Photo

Click to upload.
Professional photos build more trust.

Full Name

e.g. Alex T.

Current Status

Graduate Student

Location

London, UK

About Me

e.g. write something about yourself!

Greg Hamlet

ID Verified Part-time

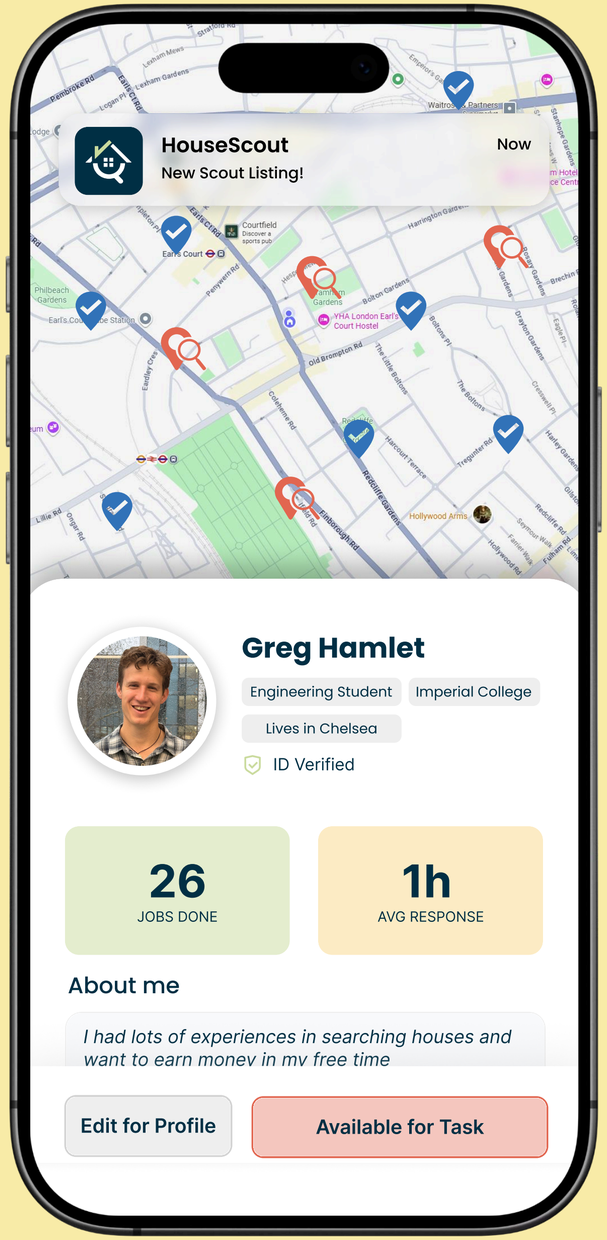
Scouting in: Kensington & Chelsea

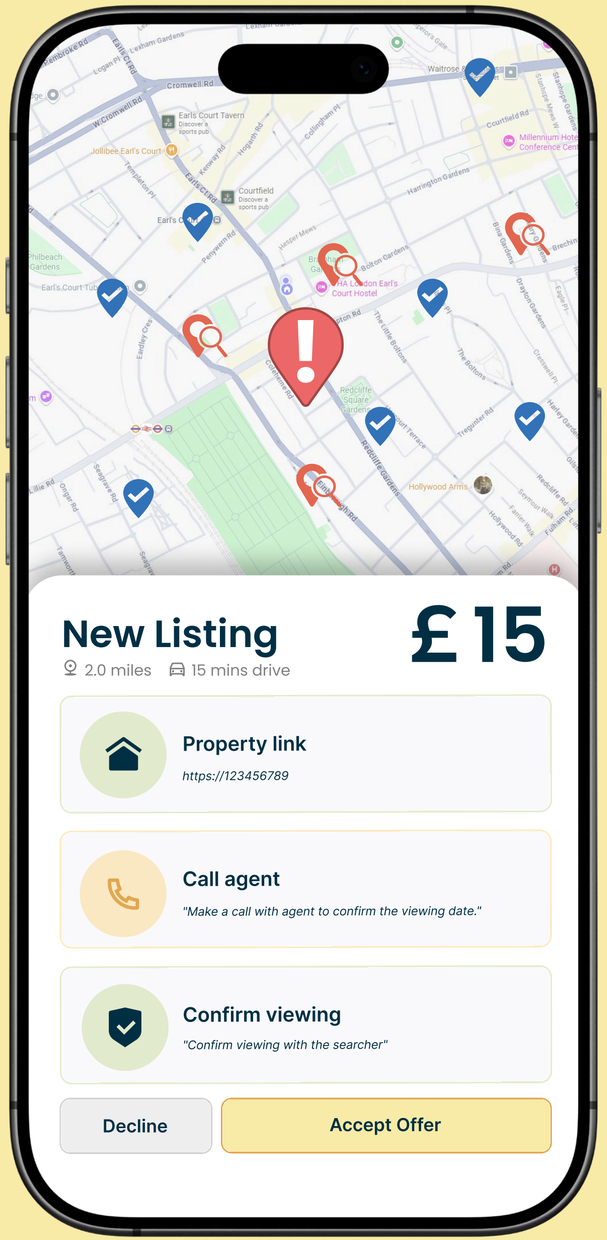
Active now

I had lots of experiences in searching houses, believes everyone should know there home and wants to earn money in my free time

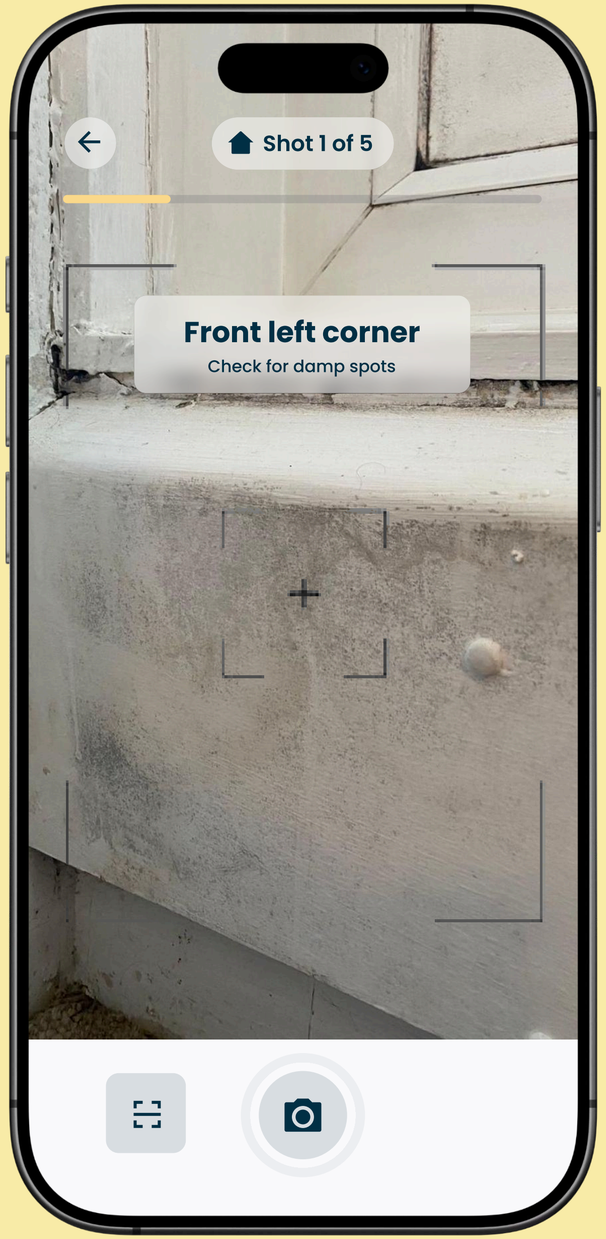
I am a Scout

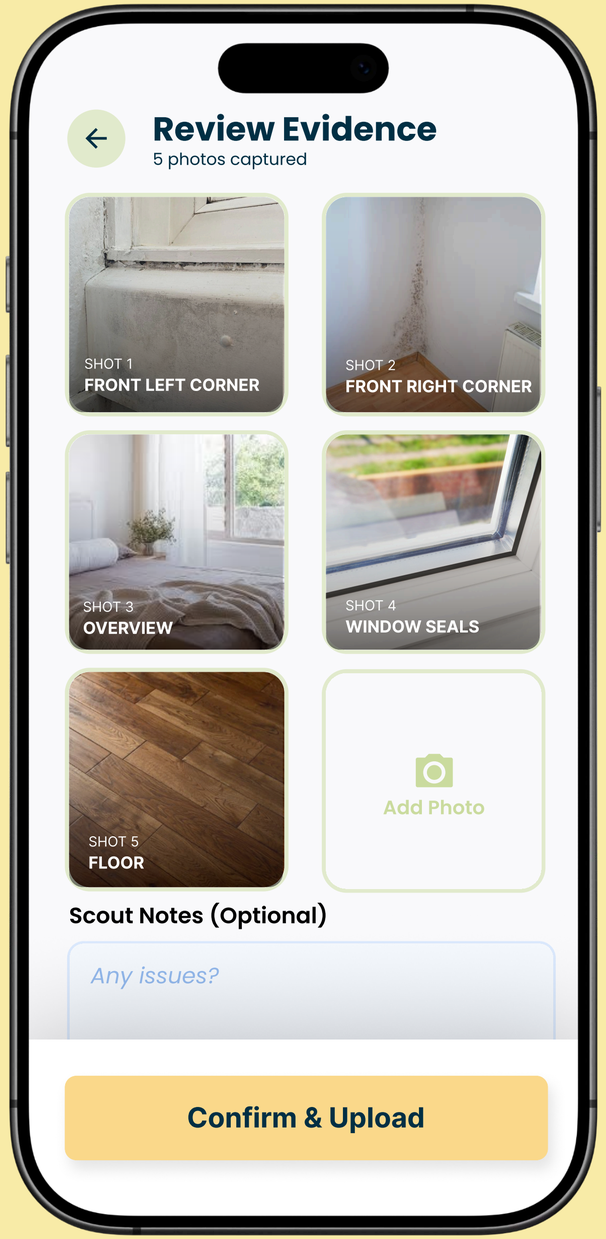
Building a Scout Database





Scout Report





Searcher Location

£

← Back

Rafi Stobbs

Imperial College | £1.8k-2.2k budget

Smart Insights

50% of ICL students live in north London, but West London offers better spaces for your budget.

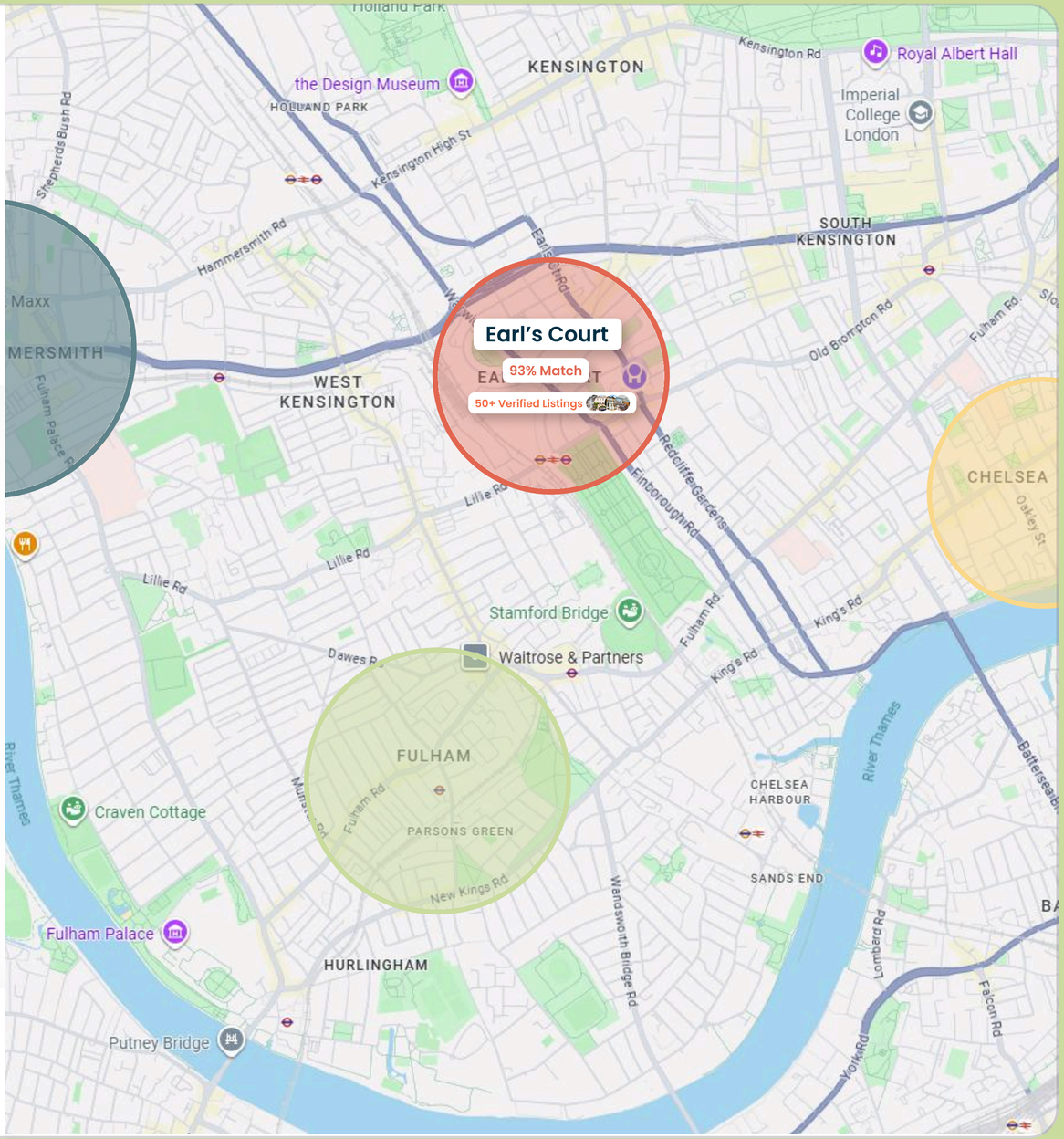
TOP RECOMMENDATIONS

Earl's Court — £1,850 pcm
"The place is very chill and safe." — Avg. rent
30 mins to Imperial | 150+ ICL Students

Chelsea — £2,250 pcm
"Very nice place to live in." — Avg. rent
20 mins to Imperial | 80+ ICL Students

Fulham — £2,300 pcm
"Green" — Avg. rent
20 mins to Imperial | 100+ ICL Students

Explore Earl's Court Listings



Report Dashboard

Back to Search

REPORT SUMMARY

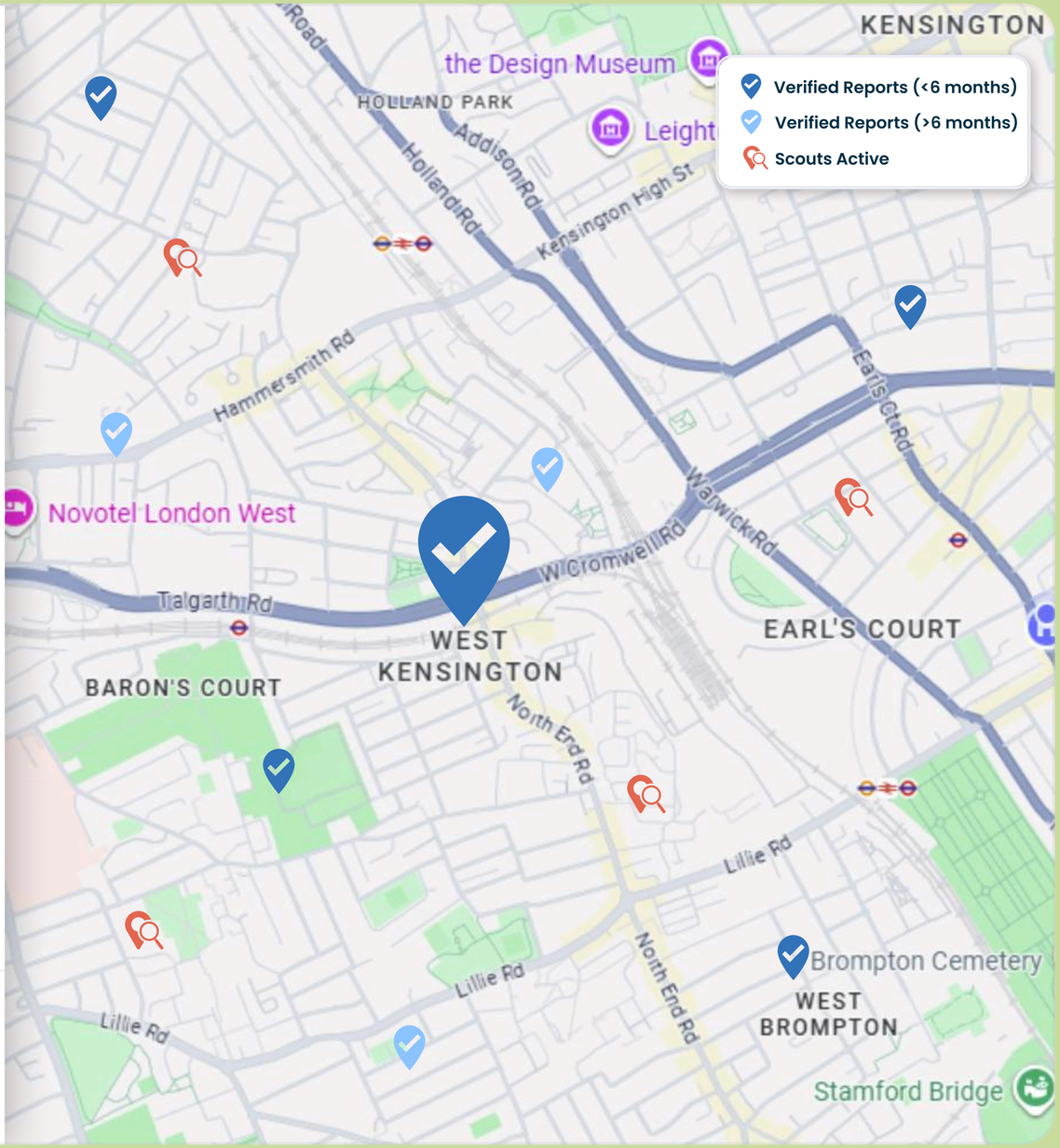
Overall condition
"Well maintained, recently renovated. No visible damp."

Noise level
"Facing main street, traffic noise audible when windows open."

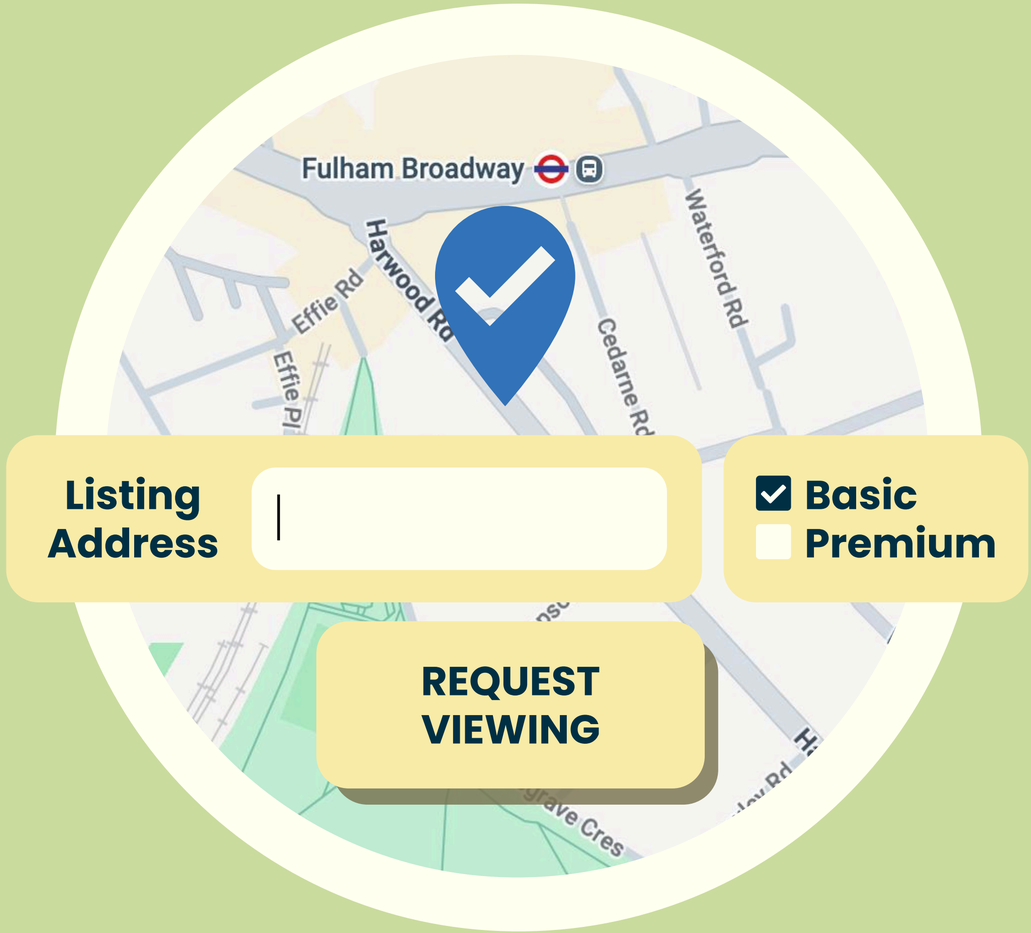
Safety feeling
"Secure entry system, well-lit street."

WALKTHROUGH VIDEO

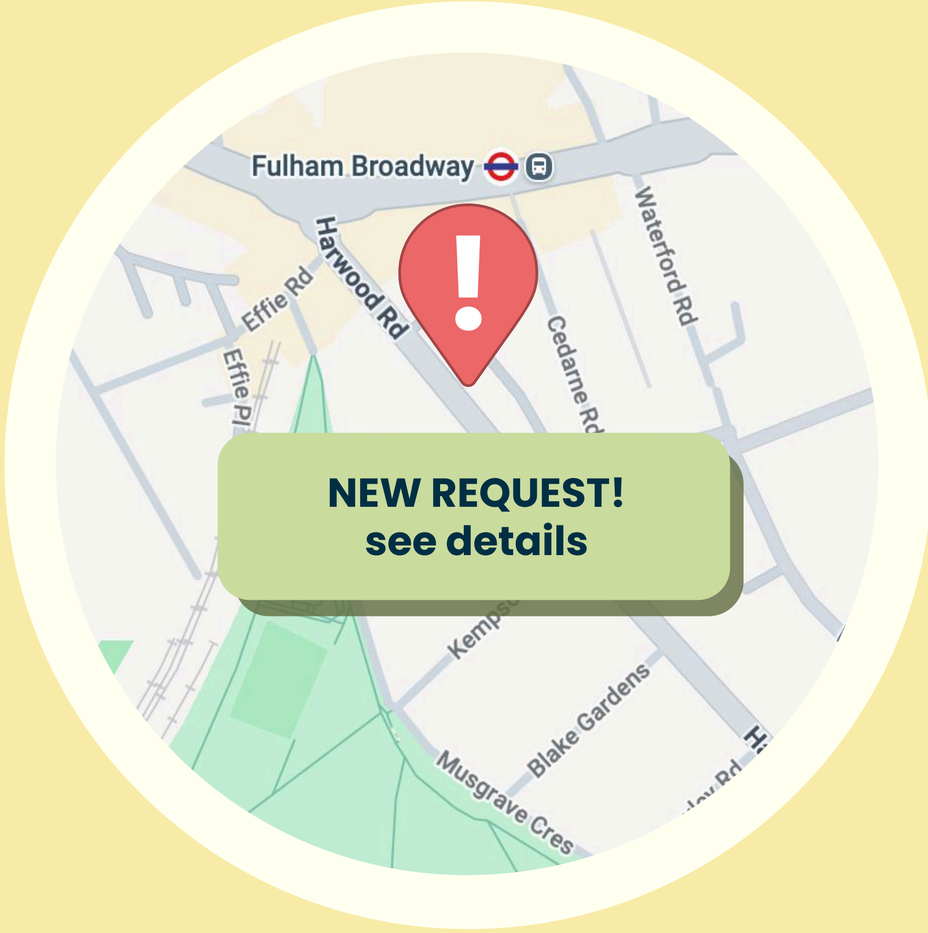
Download the report



Searcher: Viewing



Scout



She feels **confident** to make an offer.

- **happy** with the area
- **transparent** viewing
- **informed** decision

You choose your ideal bundle!

1 week bundle

£ 9.99/1 week

Your viewing week, covered

Access to:
- whole report database
- **5%** OFF Basic Viewing request

Perfect for:
- A busy week of
- Final stages of your search
- Final checks before an offer

Select

3 weeks bundle

£ 19.99/3 weeks

Ensure you find your ideal property

Access to:
- whole report database
- **10%** OFF Basic Viewing request
- **10%** OFF Premium Viewing request

Perfect for:
- The beginning of your home seacrh
- Searching at a steady pace
- Avoiding rushed, un-informed decisions

Select

6 weeks bundle

£ 35.99/6 week

Most property searches take 6 weeks

Access to:
- whole report database
- **20%** OFF Basic Viewing request
- **20%** OFF Premium Viewing request

Perfect for:
- The beginning of your home search
- Searching at a steady pace
- Staying confident and finding ideal rental property

Select

FREE

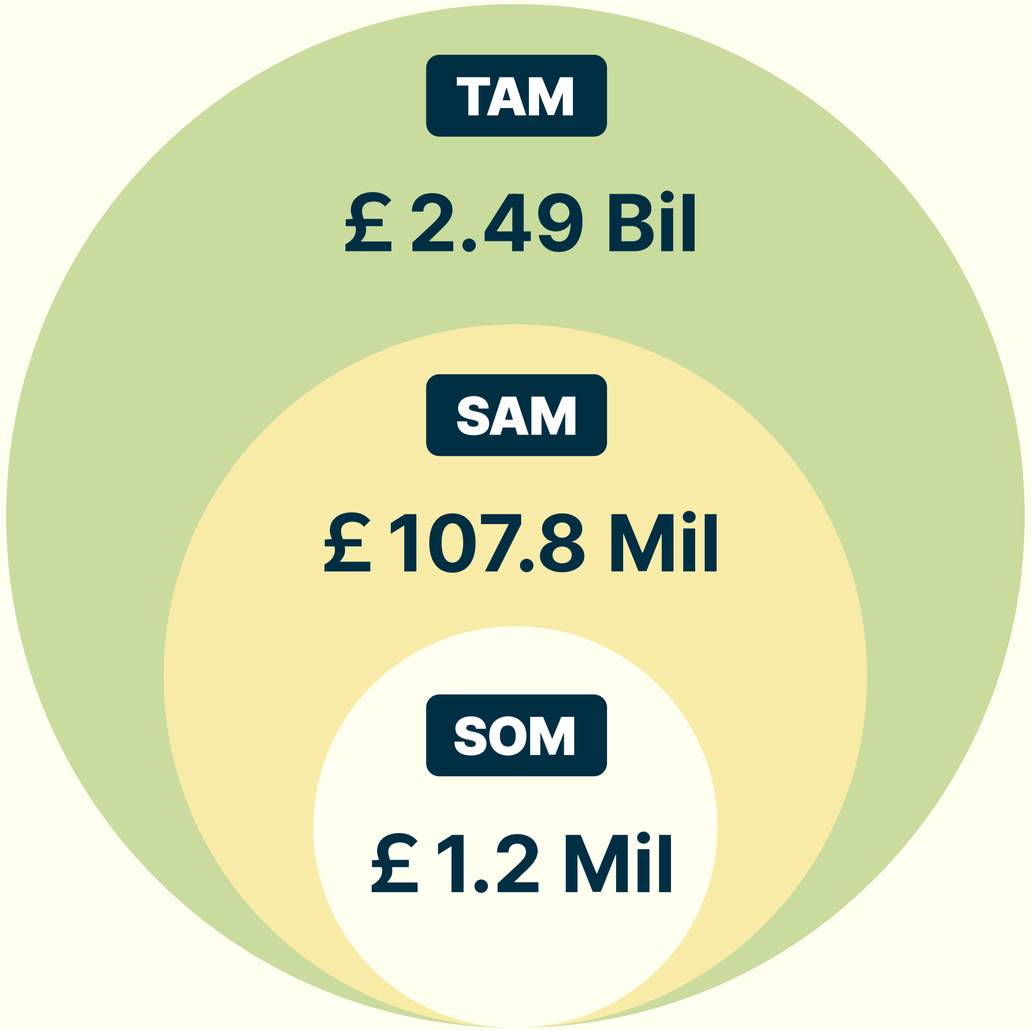
Find high quality reports

Access to:
- reports from 1 month ago to see the qulity of our reports

Perfect for:
- Internationals looking to rent in London
- Internationals want to learn more about renting landscape

Select

Market Size



Global International Moving Market

UK International Moving Market

London International Moving Market

***Assumption According to Business Calculation**
The market size is calculated by the amount of potential users (5% SOM) times average revenue we can make from one customer, which is set as £120 now

Route to Market

Who’s Behind Us?

User Validation

40 target user interviews

70 positive survey responses

Industry Validation

CHESTERTONS

Gray’s
RESIDENTIAL

Meet Our Team!

Thank you for listening!

HouseScout

Unbiased viewings from abroad

Supplementary Slides

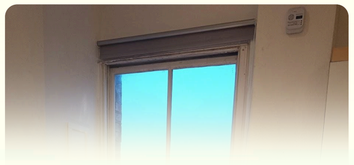
1. Extra feature
2. Business model
3. Market opportunity
4. Business flow map
5. Calculations for pricing
6. Assumptions & pricing for business model
7. Value Proposition Customer
8. Value proposition Scout
9. Market Strategy
10. Scout vetting process
11. Interviews and Surveys
12. Competitor Analysis

1. Scout Still Support tenants during tenancy

DEPOSIT SECURITY

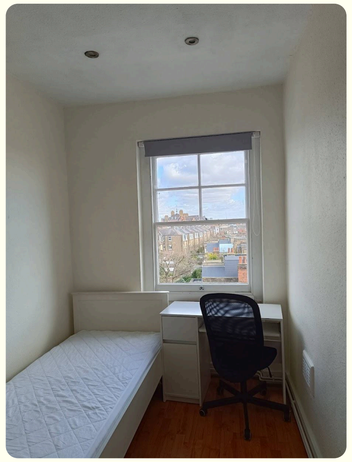
MOVE IN & MOVE OUT REPORT

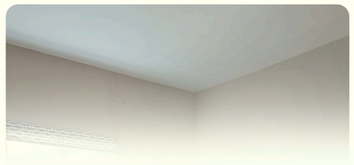
15th October 2024
Move in



- Bedroom 1 has the same window damage noticed in move in
- Desk has been upgraded
- Slight chip in paint near bed
- Mould in kitchen was

23rd September 2025
Move out





2. Business Model

Direct B2C

Subscription Mode

The searchers choose the bundle themselves

Basic Scout Service

With a one-time payment fee of £ 20

Premium Scout Service

With a one-time payment fee of £ 50

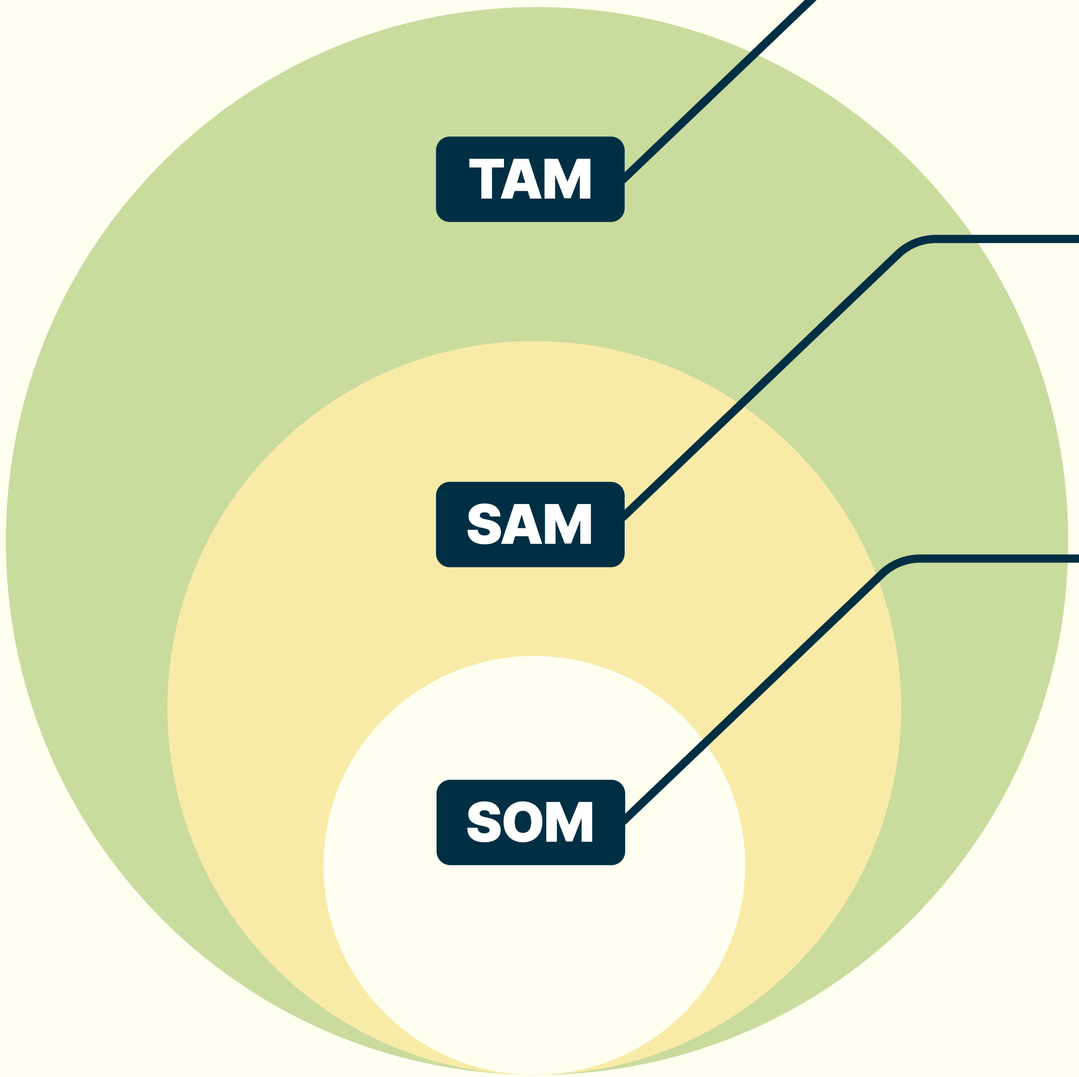
B2B Database Partnership

Verified Property Data can be purchased for other commercial purposes

Affiliate Marketing

Promoting Other companies' Products and Services

3. Market Opportunity



20,750,000
Global Internationals moving every year

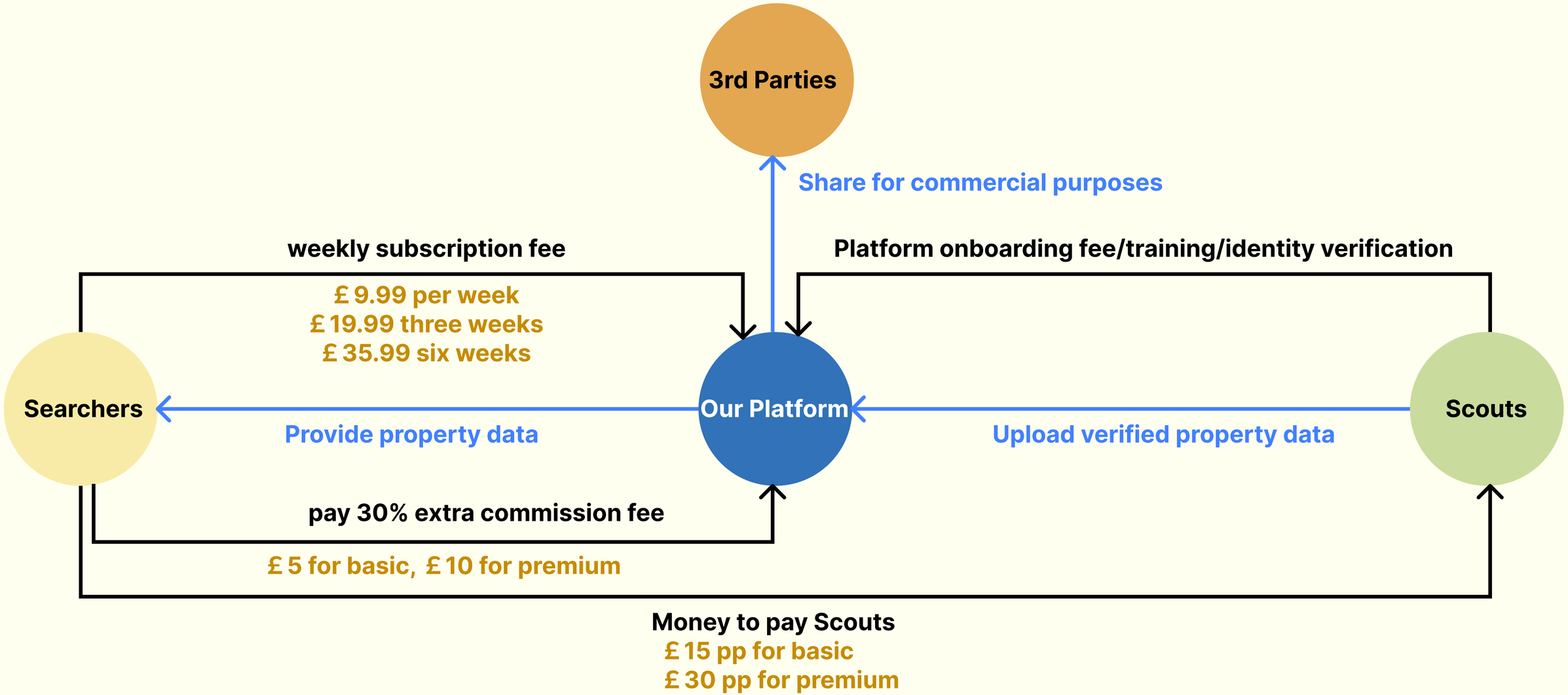
898,000
International people move into the UK every year

200,000
International people move into London every year*

***Cross Validation**

Other data sources indicate that international people move in London each year account for approximately 25% of the total number of international people move into the UK, which aligns with the data here

4. Business Flow Map



5. Calculations

Assume Searcher need 3 basic viewing service and
1 premium viewing service before final decision

	1-Week Bundle £ 9.99	3-Week Bundle £ 19.99	6-Week Bundle £ 35.99
Bundle Fee	9.99	19.99	35.99
Basic Viewing	3*20*0.95=57	3*20*0.9=54	3*20*0.8=48
Premium Viewing	1*50*1=50	1*50*0.9=45	1*50*0.8=40
Total Payment	9.99+57+50=117	19.99+54+45=119	35.99+48+40=124
Basic View Profit	20*0.95-15=4	20*0.9-15=3	20*0.8-15=1
Premium View Profit	50-30=20	50*0.9-30=15	50*0.8-30=10
Platform Total Profit	9.99+4*3+20*1=42	19.99+3*3+15*1=44	35.99+1*3+10*1=46

6. Assumptions & Calculations for Business Model

- We can reach **5%** customers of SOM
- Each people will view **5 properties** before tenancy
- Each Scout can spend **7h** to view properties per week (7 viewings pw)
- Scouts get **£15** for 1 basic viewing, our platform take **30%** of the total price as commission fee

Total Amount of Customers: 200,000*5%=**10,000** people
Total Amount of Viewings: 10,000*5=**50,000** viewings

Amount of viewings need: 50,000/52=962 viewings pw
Amount of Scouts we need: 962/7=**138** Scouts
Cost to build up our database=15*138*12= £24,725
Assume cost to maintain website= £15,000 per year
Total Fixed Cost = **39,720**

Key Assumptions

We have 10,000 customers, 10% of them will use free trial only, 35% of them will buy 1-week bundle to try the platform, 15% will buy 3-week bundle, and the rest 40% will buy 6-week bundle

Customer Composition

Tier 0: 10,000*10%=1,000
Tier 1: 10,000*35%=3,500
Tier 2: 10,000*15%=1,500
Tier 3: 10,000*40%=4,000

Profit Structure

Basic	Premium
Tier 1: £4	Tier 1: £20
Tier 2: £3	Tier 2: £15
Tier 3: £1	Tier 3: £10

Profit Breakdown

Tier 1

Total Amount of User
- 3,500
- **3 basic viewing services only**

Subscription Profit
- 3,500*9.99= £34,965

Basic Viewing Profit
- 3,500*4*3= £42,000

Total Profit
- 34,965+42,000
- **£76,965**

Tier 2

Total Amount of User
- 1,500
- **3 basic + 1 Premium viewing services**

Subscription Profit
- 1,500*19.99= £29,985

Basic Viewing Profit
- 1,500*3*3= £13,500

Premium Viewing Profit
- 1,500*15*1= £22,500

Total Profit
- 29,985+13,500+22,500
- **£65,985**

Tier 3

Total Amount of User
- 4,000
- **5 basic + 2 Premium viewing services**

Subscription Profit
- 4,000*35.99= £143,960

Basic Viewing Profit
- 4,000*1*5= £20,000

Premium Viewing Profit
- 4,000*10*2= £80,000

Total Profit
- 143,960+20,000+80,000
- **£243,960**

Net Profit: £347,190

7. User (Searcher) Value Proposition

Products & Services

- Platform Provides personalised recommendation for rental region/ location
- Unbiased report following a list of criteria for users to understand the property
- Premium option allows for an unbiased conversation & viewing of property with a scout

Secondary services:

- Deposit security (time stamped photos taken by scouts)
- Contract Sanity Checks

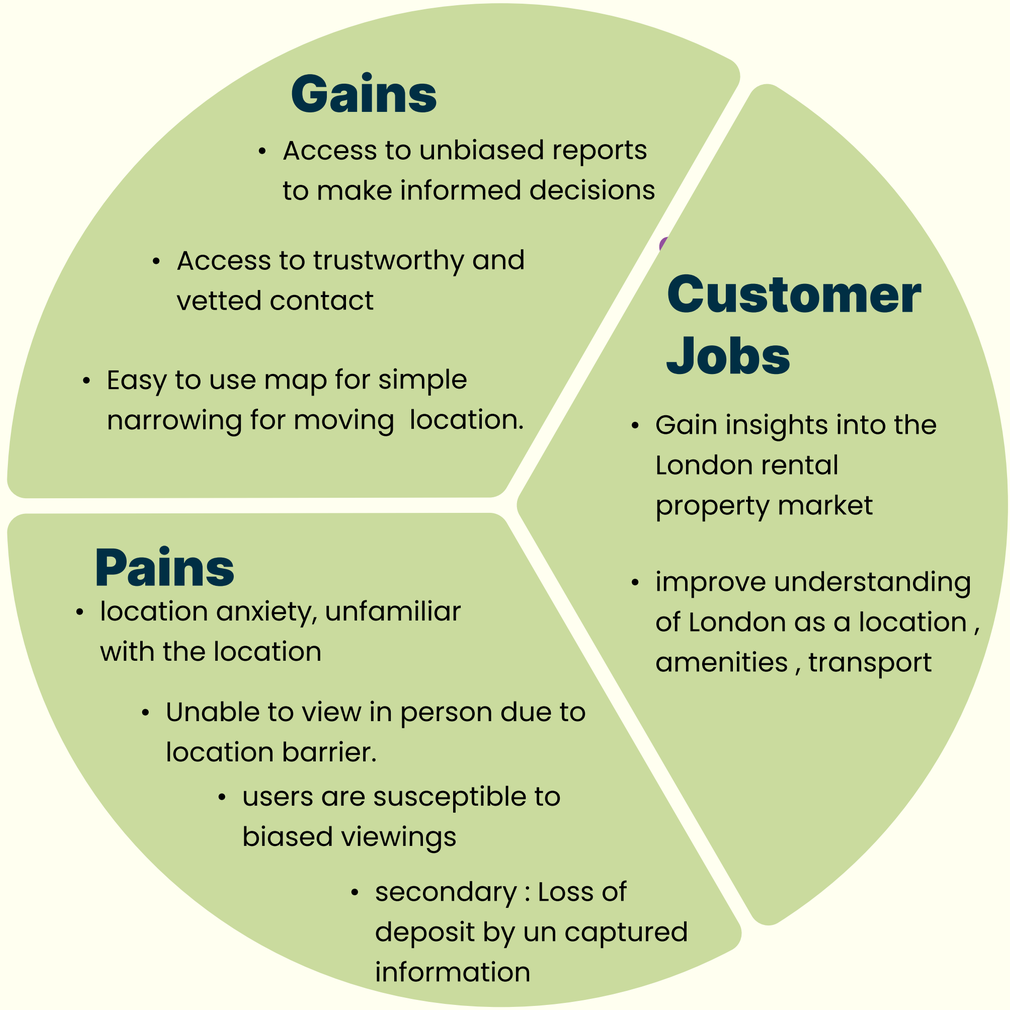
Gain Creators

- Empowers users with an unbiased, transparent view of the property.
- Educates users about the location and why it would be a good fit for their needs and requirements

Pain Relievers

- Stops move in shock when property does not match the listing photos
- Provides a location suited to the users needs

Fit



8. Scout Value Proposition

Product & Services

- Platform that matches scouts with international tenants needing property viewings
- Pre-built report templates and guided checklists
- Job notifications based on location, schedule, and preferences
- Integrated photo/video submission tools as well as call option
- Safety guidelines and verification systems

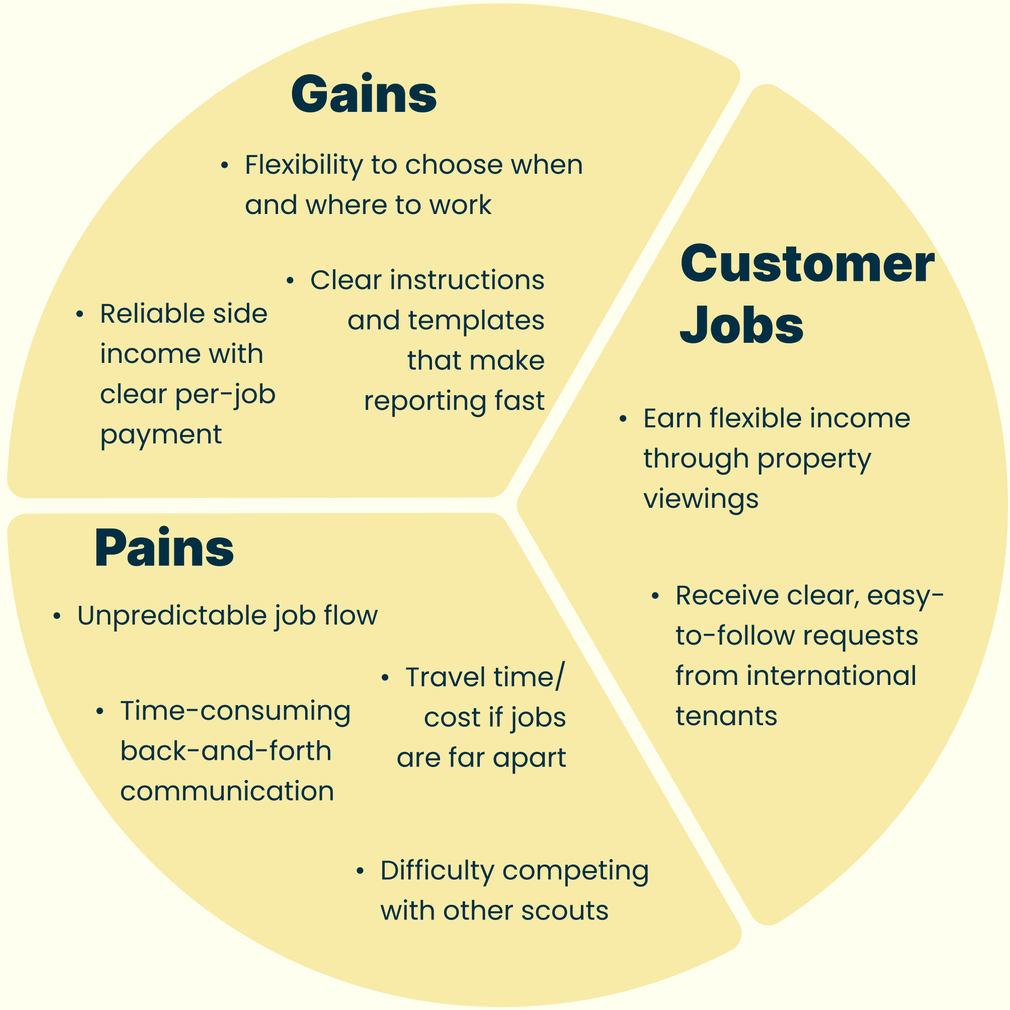
Gain Creators

- Real-time request notification
- High-efficiency reporting tools ensuring quick, standardised report

Pain Relievers

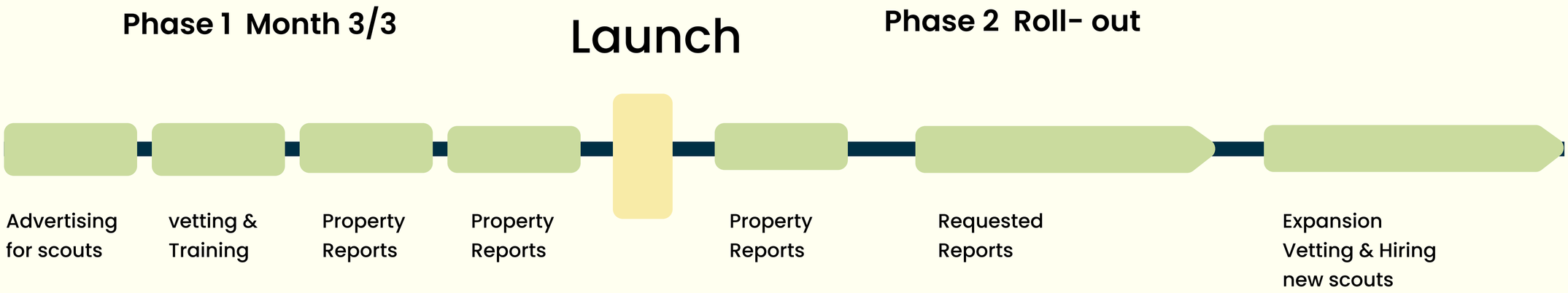
- Clear instructions eliminate uncertainty about what internationals request
- Location-based job matching reduces travel length
- Guaranteed payment removes financial anxiety

Fit

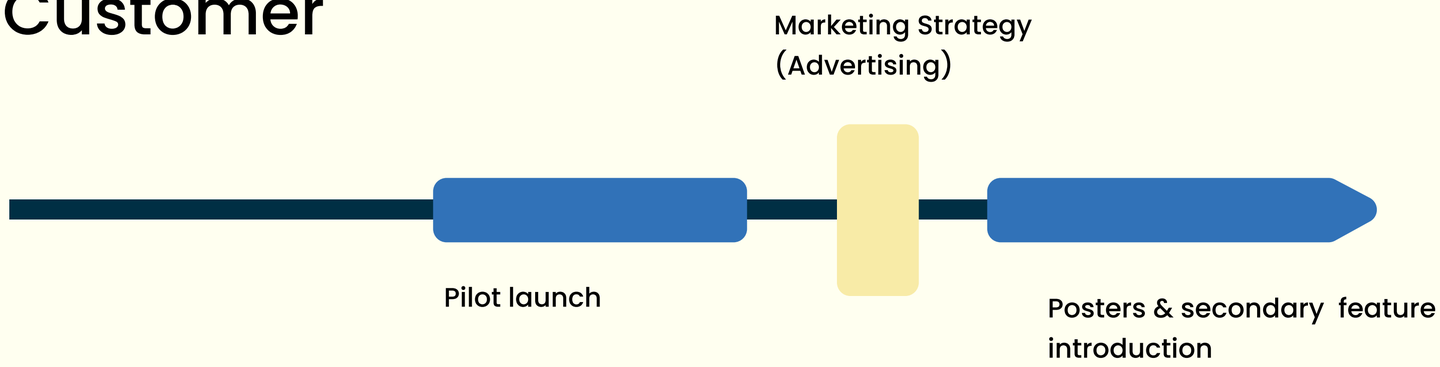


9. Route to Market

Scout



Customer



9. Marketing Strategy

Partnerships:

→ international employers

→Universities & student

→Immigration Consultancies

→ Relocation agencies

SEO

Referral Schemes:

→ Social Media

→ Influencers

10. Scout Vetting Process

Only 2 Day Process

Complete Application Form

Provide Bio

Identity Documentation & DBS Check

Provide Photographic ID

Video Interview

Undergo Training

Membership Agreement

Scout!

Similar to staffing ageny jobs

11. Interviews & Survey (Key quotes)

15 Agencies

'We want tenants to **know what the property looks like before moving** in, we **don't want to have problems** from day one' - Grays

'international students will have the most issues in the future- Horton & Garton

'We may start encouraging our landlords to rent unfurnished properties so tenants stay longer - Chestertons

10 Landlords

'I want my tenant to **like** it, to **stay in the property long term**... empty property **costs money**' - Oya

'My **rentals are an investment'** - Michael

'I like a tenant to **care for the property** , I want my property to look the same as i gave it' - Cem

40 Tenants & Survey reponses

Tell us about **your** rental searching experience!

' Viewings take up **so much time**' - Jennifer

'It was a hassle **renting from abroad** I used my **flatmates boyfriend** he noticed things I would not have , like the windows were **single glazed**' - Emily

' I **asked a flatemates dad** to view our last property ... he has **more experience** - Sarah

' **Commute** was **more annoying** than **expected**.' - Survey Response

' Happy with where I moved in, as **someone I trusted verified** that **it was a good property** by viewing it for me first- Survey response

' It **costs money to travel** , I can't take a **train to London** every time i find something good, It just does not make sense financially' - Habid

'on top of finding flatmates that agree on pricing quality of housing. You **always end up lowering your standards and paying more**.- Survey response

12. PropTech Market Porters 5 forces Tool

Threat of New Entrants: Moderate

Rightmove/Zoopla duopoly (328M+ combined monthly visits) creates powerful network effects which presents High barriers to entry of a similar platform. OnTheMarket struggled despite agent backing, achieving only 21M visits. Brand recognition and two-sided marketplace lock-in make portal competition nearly impossible for new entrants.

749 active UK proptech companies show market accessibility. Cloud infrastructure reduces capital requirements. However, established players like Goodlord and Viewber have integration advantages and brand trust.

UK-specific regulatory complexity (Right to Rent, tenant fees ban, EPC requirements) adds development costs but creates opportunities for compliance-focused solutions.

Bargaining Powers of Buyers : High

Estate/letting agents face MODERATE power as they must advertise on Rightmove/Zoopla despite high fees.

Individual landlords wield HIGH power with numerous free alternatives (PropertyJinni, Landlord Studio, Property Hawk PM3s) and low switching costs.

Property seekers have VERY HIGH power—zero cost, instant switching between portals, driving continuous platform innovation.

This forces aggressive feature development, competitive pricing, and quality improvements across the sector.

Industry Rivalry

Portal Market: MODERATE rivalry with Rightmove/Zoopla duopoly dominating, with 90%+ listing traffic and strong pricing power. OnTheMarket distant third demonstrates difficulty challenging incumbents.

Software Market: HIGH rivalry with 749 active proptech companies, highly fragmented with multiple players competing intensely to integrate the next software boost.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers: Moderate

Most suppliers have limited power due to commoditization and alternatives. Virtual tour technology suppliers like Matterport hold MODERATE power as market leader (£150-300 per property) but face UK competition from EyeSpy360, Giraffe 360, iGuide, and budget options . Developer talent shows LOW to MODERATE power with large UK tech workforce, though proptech specialists command premiums.

Landlords hold HIGH power with the supplement of their properties to agencies who then supply them to the tenants. They have high power as they can pick and choose who the allow to rent the property. A factor which is clear as agencies battle to sign landlords portfolios.

Threat of Substitutes : Moderate

Traditional estate agents pose LOW threat as they are complementary not competitive, using portals themselves to advertise. Direct property websites pose LOW threat lacking Rightmove/Zoopla traffic. Niche platforms serve specific segments without threatening market leaders. On-demand services like Viewber use a compliment system rather than substitute—enabling agents to extend capabilities without hiring staff, actually growing market size by facilitating more viewings.

12. Indirect Competitors: House Search Portals

Strengths

- Dominate Market position with two companies controlling 90% of the UK property search traffic
- High brand recognition
- Huge database of agents and properties
- High revenue and profitability
- Low cost to user as is free to use
- Zero customer acquisition cost

Weaknessess

- Agent difficulties with high fees, increasing resentment
- limited differentiation in the market
- Frustration leads to competitor creation for example OnTheMarket
- Limited revenue diversification
- International weaknessess
- Low customer service to Tenants

Opportunities

- Could include more help post viewings and offer stage
- international expansion to europe and other continents
- Include more renter friendly features
- Create rightmove properties/enter the market
- Selling data and API

Threats

- Agent rebellion with dissatisfaction
- Regulatory intervention from goverment which will disrupt features - listing images
- Un-happy customers that will look to competitors for more user first platforms
- Proptech innovation could remove these platforms and change the landscape

12. Direct Competitor Case Study : Viewber

Viewber has strong first-mover advantage in UK on-demand viewing market with proven model and impressive growth.
Key to success is that supply viewing agents , to host viewing sessions for agencies and landlords, NOT VIEWINGS in replacement of potential TENANTS. However they do offer a virtual viewing for tenants if need be but are ultimately being paid by the landlord therefore present with bias, this is also at a large fee. The gig economy model is validated, but must navigate regulatory risks and defend against competition.

Strengths

- 3,000+ vetted "Viewbers" providing nationwide UK coverage
- 300,000+ appointments completed since 2016
- £3M raised with notable investors
- 50%+ market share in UK auction sector
- Scalable gig economy model with variable cost structure
- Comprehensive services: viewing hosting, 360° tours, photography, EPCs, key management
- 460% year-over-year growth (2018)
- Only company that provides these services at the moment

Weaknessess

- Quality control challenges with freelancers with viewer agents consistency varies
- Lower brand recognition for partnerships
- Geographic coverage depends on local Viewber availability—some postcodes limited
- Acts as middleman as agents could hire viewers directly or provide the service themselves
- Constant training overhead to maintain professional quality

Opportunities

- UK private rental sector growing and need services
- Agent recruitment crisis makes more outsourced solutions
- Geographic expansion to other countires
- API partnerships with listing platform.
- Data monetization with viewing records to provide market insights
- White-label solutions for large agencies or relocation services

Threats

- Direct competition from copycat on-demand viewing services
- Larger agencies building in-house flexible staffing
- Virtual viewing technology (VR, 3D tours) reducing need for in-person viewings
- Reputation risk from single bad viewing experience
- Commoditization of viewing services creates pricing pressure
- Insurance/liability issues from property damage or security incidents
- Established players adding viewing marketplaces to their platform